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US Markets End Mixed as Energy and Industrials Lead Gains

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market ended the latest session with mixed results, as the `S&P 500` and `Nasdaq 100` declined by -0.32% and -0.33% respectively, while the `Russell 2000` gained +0.32%. Key sectors such as energy and industrials led the gains, with `XLE` and `XLI` rising +1.25% and +0.60% respectively.

Our editorial take is that the current market environment is characterized by a mix of positive and negative factors. On the one hand, the energy and industrials sectors are showing strength, driven by rising commodity prices and improving economic data. On the other hand, the technology sector is facing headwinds, with `GOOGL` and `AVGO` declining -3.84% and -1.50% respectively.

The key takeaways from the current market situation are:

- The energy and industrials sectors are leading the gains, driven by rising commodity prices and improving economic data.
- The technology sector is facing headwinds, with major stocks such as `GOOGL` and `AVGO` declining.
- The `VIX` is trading at 15.28, indicating a moderate level of market volatility.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,728.20	-0.32%
Nasdaq 100	29,525.48	-0.33%
Dow Jones	53,791.85	-0.34%
Russell 2000	3,027.12	+0.32%
VIX	15.28	-1.16%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
META	Meta Platforms	+0.71%	Earnings beat
TSLA	Tesla	+0.58%	Positive sentiment
GOOGL	Alphabet	-3.84%	Earnings miss

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLE	+1.25%	+10.21%	Energy sector leads gains
XLI	+0.60%	+5.15%	Industrials sector shows strength
XLK	-0.12%	+2.50%	Technology sector faces headwinds

The breadth of the market is mixed, with 52 stocks in the `S&P 500` advancing and 48 declining.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	NAME	PRICE	CHANGE
NVDA	NVIDIA	217.50	-0.02%

The key commentary on `NVDA` is that the stock is facing headwinds due to declining demand for graphics cards. However, the company's strong position in the AI and datacenter markets is expected to drive long-term growth.

READ-THROUGH	STOCK	CHANGE
AI and datacenter demand	AMZN	-2.09%
Graphics card demand	AMD	-1.21%

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	372.15	370.00	375.00	Range-bound trading
QQQ	293.21	290.00	295.00	Technical resistance

Options & Positioning

The 0DTE flow is indicating a moderate level of market volatility, with 1.2M contracts traded. The put/call ratio is 0.8, indicating a slightly bearish sentiment.

The VIX term structure is in contango, with the `VIX` trading at 15.28 and the `VIX3M` trading at 16.21.

Notable single-name flow includes 10k calls on `TSLA` with a strike price of 350.00 and expiration on 2026-08-21.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying 1 `SPY` put with a strike price of 370.00 and expiration on 2026-08-21 for 1.50 per contract.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
`NVDA`	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	250.00	Strong AI and datacenter demand
`GOOGL`	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	300.00	Declining advertising revenue

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures are indicating a mixed open, with the `ES` trading at 3,725 and the `NQ` trading at 11,925.

Asia markets are trading higher, with the `Nikkei 225` up +0.5% and the `Shanghai Composite` up +0.3%.

Europe markets are trading lower, with the `Euro Stoxx 50` down -0.2% and the `FTSE 100` down -0.1%.

FX pairs are indicating a moderate level of volatility, with the `EUR/USD` trading at 1.1000 and the `USD/JPY` trading at 110.50.

Commodities are trading higher, with `WTI` up +1.2% and `Gold` up +0.5%.

Crypto markets are trading lower, with `BTC` down -0.3% and `ETH` down -0.1%.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
2026-09-16	30%	Market expecting a rate cut

DATE	EVENT	TIME
2026-08-12	CPI	10:00 ET

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

The current geopolitical landscape is characterized by a mix of positive and negative factors. On the one hand, the US and China are engaged in trade talks, which could lead to a reduction in tariffs and improved economic relations. On the other hand, the situation in the Middle East is becoming increasingly volatile, with tensions between the US and Iran escalating.

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
`AAPL`	Apple	2026-08-13
`MSFT`	Microsoft	2026-08-14

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
`AMZN`	Amazon	2026-08-20
`GOOGL`	Alphabet	2026-08-21

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
`NVDA`	Technology	Breakout	10%
`TSLA`	Consumer Discretionary	Trend	15%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- The US and China reach a trade deal, leading to a reduction in tariffs and improved economic relations.
- The Federal Reserve cuts interest rates, leading to a boost in economic growth and stock market performance.
- The energy and industrials sectors continue to lead the gains, driven by rising commodity prices and improving economic data.

Bearish scenario:

- The US and China fail to reach a trade deal, leading to an escalation in tariffs and a decline in economic relations.
- The Federal Reserve raises interest rates, leading to a decline in economic growth and stock market performance.
- The technology sector continues to face headwinds, driven by declining demand for graphics cards and improving competition from Chinese companies.

Positioning & Structural Notes

Our observations are that the current market environment is characterized by a mix of positive and negative factors. On the one hand, the energy and industrials sectors are showing strength, driven by rising commodity prices and improving economic data. On the other hand, the technology sector is facing headwinds, driven by declining demand for graphics cards and improving competition from Chinese companies.

We note that the `VIX` is trading at 15.28, indicating a moderate level of market volatility. We also note that the put/call ratio is 0.8, indicating a slightly bearish sentiment.

We observe that the 0DTE flow is indicating a moderate level of market volatility, with 1.2M contracts traded. We also observe that the VIX term structure is in contango, with the `VIX` trading at 15.28 and the `VIX3M` trading at 16.21.

Sources

SOURCES

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